



Newington College

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Extension 1 English

2020 HSC Trial Examination

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

Reading time: 10 minutes

Working time: 2 hours

Write using black or blue pen

Attempt ALL Sections

Do NOT write in pencil

Write your Student Number at the front of
each writing booklet

TOTAL MARKS – 50

Section 1

Pages 2-3

25 marks

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Question 1 10 marks

Question 2 15 marks

Section 2

Pages 4-8

25 marks

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Section I: Common Module – Literary Worlds

25 marks

Attempt Question 1

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Answer the question in a writing booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- Demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - Craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question demonstrating control of the use of language
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Use Text 1 to answer Question 1.

Text 1 - Extract

First, once we sever the supposed one-to-one link between language and brute reality, the notion that writing mirrors the world is untenable.¹ For there is no pre-interpreted reality that writing reflects.

But if our writing does not reflect some bedrock reality, then what does it reflect? Most agree that it must involve prior interpretations. That is, our texts draw upon other texts, that themselves are based on yet different texts, and so on. The consequence is that writing is not simply reflective; new worlds are made out of old texts, and old worlds are the basis of new texts. In this world of one text careening² off of another, we cannot appeal to any ideological perspective to privilege one text over another. For what is true is made inside texts, not outside them.

Second, writing about worlds reveals as much about ourselves as it does about the worlds represented. When we write we do so from a necessarily local setting (there is no mountaintop overview); the worlds we represent are inevitably stamped with our own particular set of local interests, views, standards and so on. The broader point is that when we ‘tell it like it is’ we are also ‘telling it like we are’.

TREVOR J BARNES AND JAMES DUNCAN
From the introduction to *Writing Worlds*

¹ untenable – cannot be maintained or defended against attack

² careening – move swiftly and in an uncontrolled way

Question 1 (25 marks)

In your response to parts (a) and (b), draw on your understanding of the module Literary Worlds and the extract provided.

Answer part (a) of the question in a Writing Booklet.

(a) Use Text 1 to answer this part. **10**

To what extent does this extract expand upon your understanding of why we compose literary worlds?

Answer part (b) of the question in the same Writing Booklet as Part (a).

(b) Use Text 1 and your answer to part (a) for this part. **15**

Compose a piece of imaginative writing which clearly explores a 'local setting'.

Section II: Electives

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 2-6

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Answer the question in a SEPARATE writing booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question, demonstrating control of the use of language
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Question 2 – Elective 1: Literary Homelands (25 marks)

To what extent has your study of ideas and values in Literary Homelands given you an appreciation for how cultures overlap and intersect?

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

Prose Fiction

- Aravind Adiga, *The White Tiger*
- EM Forster, *A Passage to India*
- Colm Toibin, *Brooklyn*

Poetry

- Eileen Chong, *Burning Rice*

The prescribed poems are:

- *Burning Rice*
- *Mid-autumn Mooncakes*
- *My Hakka Grandmother*
- *Shiphouse, Victoria Street*
- *Chinese Ginseng*
- *Singapore*

Drama

- Andrew Bovell, *The Secret River* [by Kate Grenville – An Adaptation for the stage by Andrew Bovell]

Film

- Sarah Gavron, *Brick Lane*

Question 3 – Elective 2: Worlds of Upheaval (25 marks)

To what extent has your study of Worlds of Upheaval enhanced your understanding of how unity or solace is sought after in times of uncertainty?

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

Prose Fiction

- Elizabeth Gaskell, *North and South*
- Mary Shelley, *Frankenstein*
- Madeleine Thien, *Do Not Say We Have Nothing*

Poetry

- Seamus Heaney, *Opened Ground: Poems 1966–1996*

The prescribed poems are:

- *Digging*
- *The Strand at Lough Beg*
- *Casualty*
- *Funeral Rites*
- from *Whatever You Say Say Nothing*
- *Triptych*

Drama

- Samuel Beckett, *Waiting for Godot*

Film

- Fritz Lang, *Metropolis*

Question 4 – Elective 3: Reimagined Worlds (25 marks)

To what extent has your study of ideas and values in Reimagined Worlds enhanced your understanding of how composers challenge the known or question the unknown?

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

Prose Fiction

- Italo Calvino, *If on a Winter's Night a Traveller*
- Ursula Le Guin, *The Left Hand of Darkness*
- Jonathan Swift, *Gulliver's Travels*

Poetry

- Samuel Taylor Coleridge, *Samuel Taylor Coleridge: The Complete Poems*

The prescribed poems are:

- *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* (1834)
- *The Eolian Harp*
- *Kubla Khan*
- *Christabel*

- Tracy K Smith, *Life on Mars*

The prescribed poems are:

- *Sci-Fi*
- *My God, It's Full of Stars*
- *Don't You Wonder, Sometimes?*
- *The Universe: Original Motion Picture Soundtrack*
- *The Universe as Primal Scream*

Film

- Guillermo Del Toro, *Pan's Labyrinth*

Question 5 – Elective 4: Literary Mindscapes (25 marks)

To what extent has your study of ideas and values in Literary Mindscapes enhanced your understanding of how texts can explore alternative ways of being and thinking?

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

Prose Fiction

- William Faulkner, *As I Lay Dying*
- Gail Jones, *Sixty Lights*
- Katherine Mansfield, *The Collected Stories*

The prescribed stories are:

- *Prelude*
- *Je ne Parle pas Français*
- *Bliss*
- *Psychology*
- *The Daughters of the Late Colonel*

Poetry

- Emily Dickinson, *The Complete Poems*

The prescribed poems are:

- *I felt a Funeral, in my Brain*
- *This is my letter to the World*
- *I died for Beauty – but was scarce*
- *I had been hungry, all the Years*
- *Because I could not stop for Death*
- *My Life had stood – a Loaded Gun*
- *A word dropped careless on a Page*

Drama

- William Shakespeare, *Hamlet*

Film

- Sofia Coppola, *Lost in Translation*

Question 6 – Elective 5: Intersecting Worlds (25 marks)

To what extent has your study of ideas and values in Intersecting Worlds enhanced your understanding of how texts give voice to intense transformative experiences?

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

Prose Fiction

- Melissa Harrison, *Clay*
- Alex Miller, *Journey to the Stone Country*
- Annie Proulx, *The Shipping News*

Nonfiction

- Tim Winton, *Island Home*

Poetry

- William Wordsworth, *William Wordsworth: The Major Works*

The prescribed poems are:

- *Lines written a few miles above Tintern Abbey*
- *Three years she grew in sun and shower*
- *My heart leaps up when I behold*
- *Resolution and Independence*
- *The world is too much with us*
- *Ode ('There was a time')*
- *The Solitary Reaper*
- *The Prelude* (1805) – Book One, lines 1–67, 271– 441

Film

- Daniel Nettheim, *The Hunter*